

THE RETURNING HORDE



Foreign rulers began withdrawing their warriors after Clifford's magic showed every kingdom in flames.



Clifford could not explain why a hopeful song had created such terrifying images.



Angora remembered an ancient mind-vision spell from the magical library—one she had always feared to attempt.



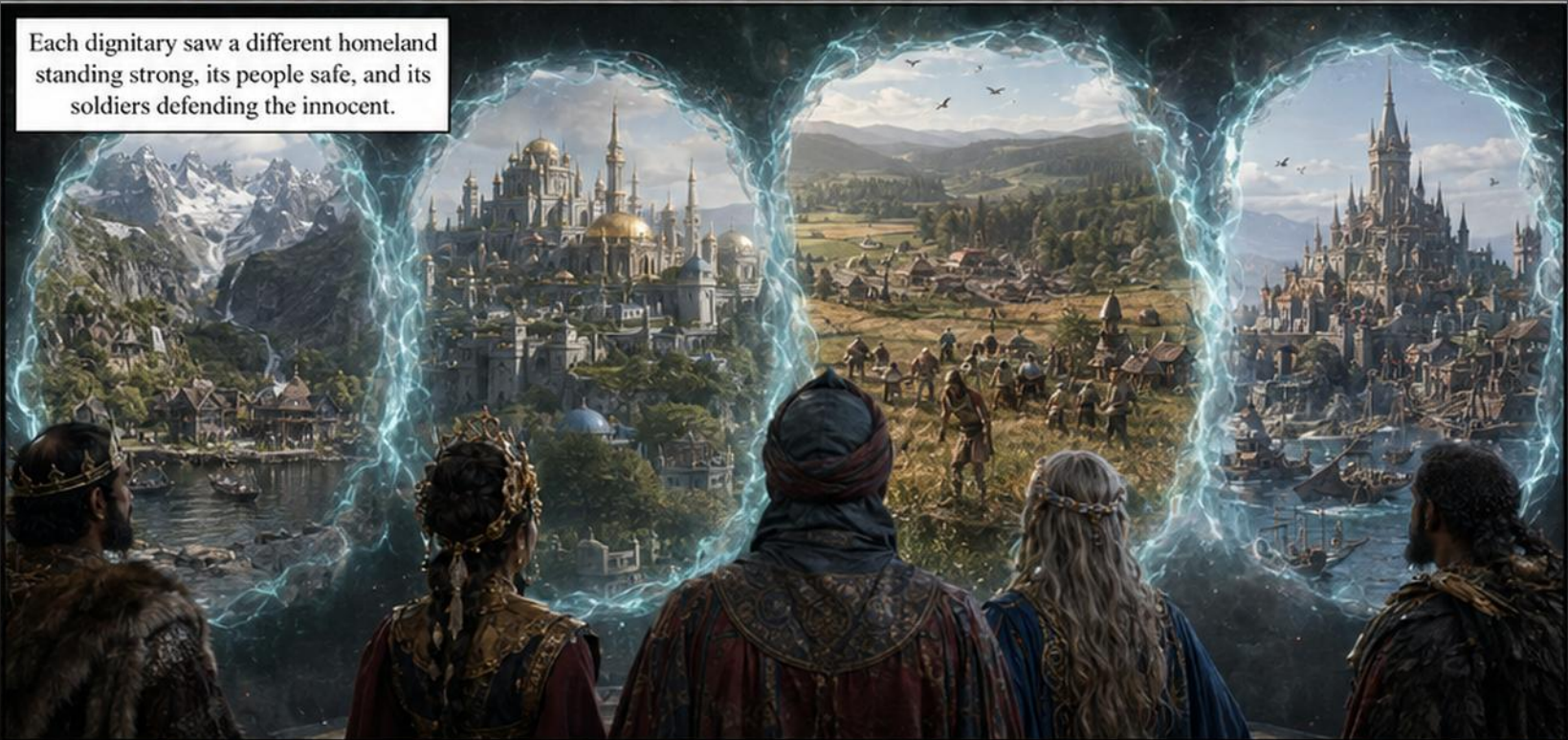
She asked the Swamp Witch to place a truthful vision directly within the rulers' minds.



The witch drew upon ancient wisdom and connected every ruler to the hope behind the academy.



Each dignitary saw a different homeland standing strong, its people safe, and its soldiers defending the innocent.



The visions did not promise that danger would disappear. They showed that cooperation could help every nation survive it.



Fear released its hold, and the rulers pledged their support to Clifford and Angora once more.



The academy's students resumed training beneath the banners of many nations.



Ancient magic had repeatedly changed their fate, so Clifford proposed returning to the magical library.



There they might find forgotten techniques capable of guiding the school they had built.



Before they could enter the library, the headmaster of a rival warrior school blocked their path.



Royal families were considering moving their champions from her academy to Clifford and Angora's new institution.



She accused the pair of stealing students and ancient knowledge that her school had guarded for generations.



Angora lowered her sword and approached the rival as a colleague rather than an enemy.



Angora argued that both schools wanted to prepare the greatest generation of fighters the world had ever known.



She invited the rival headmaster to preserve ancient texts and teach the forgotten ways of warriors at their shared academy.



No kingdom would own the knowledge, and no worthy student would be denied it.



The headmaster hesitated, because her academy's secrecy had never been motivated by pride alone.



The rival revealed that
an ancient threat was returning
after more than a thousand years.



Beyond the known lands,
a horde unlike anything in
living memory was gathering.



No single warrior, school,
or kingdom possessed the
strength to stop it.



Their academy would need
every fighter it could train
and every alliance it could forge.



The headmaster turned toward the magical library, where forgotten histories waited behind ancient doors.



Somewhere within those texts might be the only knowledge capable of defeating the returning horde.



Clifford and Angora had built a school by accident. Now it might become the world's last defense.

